

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



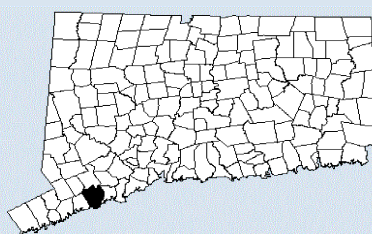
Fairfield School District

Michael Testani, Superintendent • 203-255-8371 • <http://fairfieldschools.org/>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	20
Enrollment	9,355
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$23,083
Total Expenditures ¹	\$217,878,480

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	4,593	49.1	48.3
Male	4,749	50.8	51.5
Non-Binary	13	0.1	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.2
Asian	591	6.3	5.2
Black or African American	310	3.3	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	1,311	14.0	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	515	5.5	4.7
White	6,620	70.8	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	345	3.7	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,574	16.8	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	1,774	19.0	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	*	*	52	1.1
Male	381	8.2	177	3.6
Non-Binary	*	*	0	*
Black or African American	*	*	24	7.2
Hispanic or Latino of any race	174	13.5	56	4.1
White	474	7.3	130	1.9
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	43	11.7	18	4.7
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	279	17.8	99	5.5
Students with Disabilities	254	14.8	92	4.5
District	762	8.3	229	2.4
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 739

Number of school-based arrests: 0

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Fairfield School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	675.3
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	41.5
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	115.9
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	213.8
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	13.0
School Level	52.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	19.0
Support Staff	15.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	84.8
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	76.9
School Nurses	24.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	407.3

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	2	0.2	1.4
Black or African American	9	0.9	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	22	2.1	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	1	0.1	0.1
Two or More Races	10	1.0	0.3
White	1,006	95.8	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	13.5	13.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	14	*	31	96.9
Hispanic or Latino of any race	92	97.9	119	96.7
White	495	99.0	597	98.7
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	9	*	16	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	120	96.0	160	97.6
Students with Disabilities	120	99.2	163	94.2
District	676	98.5	837	98.5
State		88.4		94.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	92	54.8
Emotional Disability	42	40.0
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	373	72.7
Other Health Impairment	327	74.1
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	217	87.9
District	1,074	69.5
State		66.8

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	177	1.9	2.6
Emotional Disability	105	1.1	1.1
Intellectual Disability	19	0.2	0.6
Learning Disability	514	5.6	6.4
Other Health Impairment	445	4.8	3.5
Other Disabilities	111	1.2	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	269	2.9	2.0
All Disabilities	1,640	17.8	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	17	1.0	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	73	4.5	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$131,387,799	\$13,920	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$16,148,759	\$1,735	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$12,964,228	\$1,393	\$905
Support services - general administration	\$881,503	\$95	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$13,575,077	\$1,459	\$1,207
Central and other support services	\$8,314,962	\$893	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$21,886,655	\$2,352	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$10,022,846	\$1,454	\$1,582
Food services	.	.	\$8
Enterprise operations	\$2,696,651	\$290	\$213
Total	\$217,878,480	\$23,083	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$16,877,694	26.2	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$3,653,068	5.7	10.2
Other Salaries	\$10,244,676	15.9	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$9,917,910	15.4	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$7,587,261	11.8	6.4
Special Education Tuition	\$11,700,733	18.2	22.2
Supplies	\$551,446	0.9	0.7
Property Services	\$40,289	0.1	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$3,825,140	5.9	8.4
Equipment	\$29,910	0.0	0.3
All Other Expenditures	.	.	0.1
Total	\$64,428,127	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		29.6	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	95.1
State	2.2
Federal	2.3
Tuition & Other	0.4

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

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Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	0	N/A
Asian	303	79.1	303	80.2	163	75.8
Black or African American	140	64.7	140	58.3	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	620	67.6	620	64.0	260	62.8
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	*	*	*	*
Two or More Races	260	80.9	260	78.9	88	80.9
White	3,394	76.8	3,391	74.1	1,449	72.8
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	227	60.5	227	61.3	92	55.1
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	4,494	76.3	4,491	73.5	1,939	72.4
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	760	64.5	759	61.6	341	61.0
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	3,961	77.7	3,959	75.1	1,690	73.8
Students with Disabilities	820	57.8	817	55.5	349	54.8
Students without Disabilities	3,901	79.3	3,901	76.6	1,682	75.1
High Needs	1,439	63.0	1,436	60.5	623	59.9
Non-High Needs	3,282	81.1	3,282	78.4	1,408	76.8
District	4,721	75.6	4,718	72.9	2,031	71.6

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at

https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	84.2	77.2	78.8	76.1	2,678	79.1
Curl Up	94.1	85.4	88.3	82.7	2,673	87.7
Push Up	87.1	76.9	79.0	75.5	2,664	79.7
Mile Run/PACER	87.0	88.0	77.1	76.2	2,642	82.2
All Tests - District	68.5	54.9	52.9	50.1	2,600	56.7
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

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Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2022-23	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	21	76.2
Hispanic or Latino of any race	90	90.0
White	573	96.0
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	19	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	179	89.4
Students with Disabilities	153	81.7
District	744	94.8
State		88.4

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2022-23 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Count	Rate (%)
Female	521	68.6
Male	*	*
Non-Binary	*	*
Black or African American	15	31.3
Hispanic or Latino	103	47.5
White	744	67.3
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	114	39.4
Students with Disabilities	56	19.0
District	989	64.4
State		44.3

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2023	Class of 2022
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	90.3	96.1
Male	82.9	95.2
Non-Binary	*	*
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	76.5	91.5
White	89.2	96.3
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	76.0	89.0
Students with Disabilities	68.7	84.7
District	86.4	95.7
State	68.4	87.2

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	75.6	75	50.0	50	100.0	63.9
	High Needs Students	63.0	75	42.0	50	84.0	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	72.9	75	48.6	50	97.3	60.2
	High Needs Students	60.5	75	40.3	50	80.7	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	71.6	75	47.8	50	95.5	61.8
	High Needs Students	59.9	75	39.9	50	79.9	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	60.4%	100%	60.4	100	60.4	58.7%
	High Needs Students	56.0%	100%	56.0	100	56.0	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	67.9%	100%	67.9	100	67.9	61.4%
	High Needs Students	60.1%	100%	60.1	100	60.1	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	71.0%	100%	35.5	50	71.0	58.9%
	Oral	68.3%	100%	34.1	50	68.3	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	8.3%	<=5%	43.4	50	86.8	17.7%
	High Needs Students	14.7%	<=5%	30.5	50	61.1	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	98.5%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	64.4%	75%	42.9	50	85.9	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		94.9%	94%	50.0	50	100.0	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		94.8%	94%	100.0	100	100.0	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		94.3%	94%	100.0	100	100.0	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		86.4%	75%	100.0	100	100.0	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		93.9% 56.7%	75%	37.8	50	75.6	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		41.7%	60%	34.7	50	69.4	55.0%
Accountability Index				1172.2	1450	80.8	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	75.0	63.0	12.0	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	75.0	60.5	14.5	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	75.0	59.9	15.1	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	94.3%	0.0%	9.9%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	98.7
	High Needs Students	96.8
Math	All Students	98.7
	High Needs Students	96.7
Science	All Students	98.1
	High Needs Students	95.9

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: 62.4

State: 49.7

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

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Fairfield School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

The Fairfield Board of Education approved a five-year District Improvement Plan in June 2022, which outlines strategic initiatives, specific actions and student achievement measures to guide the continuous improvement of Fairfield Public Schools through 2027. The Strategic Initiatives are: Academics, Social-Emotional Learning & Equity, Professional Development, Growth, Student Support, Community and Operations. Within each, specific actions are identified to have the greatest chance of impacting the instructional core, and therefore, student learning. Underlying the Plan is the expectation that all staff members, teams, departments, and schools engage regularly in the reflective practices of examining data, taking action, reviewing results, adjusting our practice, and evaluating effectiveness in a cycle of continuous improvement. We review focus areas and structures of the plan each year to measure progress and build on successes.

The staff in each of our 19 schools/programs develop their own individual School Improvement Plans, aligned to the District Improvement Plan, which include school specific actions to support a positive school climate and promote growth in student learning. Each school focuses on improving classroom instruction, interventions, and social/emotional supports. The school improvement teams develop and monitor instructional and communication strategies and goals to support the continuous improvement cycle. School teams also monitor chronic absenteeism and truancy, engaging parents in developing support plans to improve student attendance and connecting students and families with internal and external resources, as needed. Improving the quality of special education programs and services is an ongoing effort in response to the needs of our students with disabilities. Continuous professional development and consultation from experts in the field of special education and related services allows special education programming in FPS to respond to student needs at any given time.

All schools host parent events to address pertinent issues such as: transitions from elementary to middle to high school; curriculum topics, such as addressing the needs of emerging readers or how to support math learning at home; supporting students dealing with stress and anxiety; school climate issues; and the college application process, including financial aid. Our schools also provide family outreach and support to students with absentee issues. Support staff helps engage students in the many activities offered during and after school. Our schools have a process for welcoming new families and also publish regular newsletters highlighting activities and events.

All our schools have active PTAs and parents are actively involved as classroom volunteers, reading buddies, School Climate Committee members, fundraisers to support classroom technology, workers to support our many school gardens, and as members of our curriculum and textbook approval committees. Several of our schools house before and after school programs, some of which are also supported by our PTAs. Our student management system and our district & school websites promote continuous and effective communication between our parents, students, staff, and the community.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Fairfield Public Schools participates in the Open Choice Program with Bridgeport Public Schools. Approximately 100 students from Bridgeport attend our schools from grades one through twelve. CES uses a lottery system to select students, who are welcomed into schools throughout FPS, with most remaining through graduation. Many FPS students participate in magnet and vocational programs offered by surrounding towns. Twelve FPS students attend Six to Six Magnet School, seven students attend Interdistrict Discovery Magnet School, thirteen students attend Fairchild Wheeler Interdistrict Magnet High School, seventeen students attend the Regional Center for the Arts in Trumbull, and 72 students attend the Aquaculture Program. A small number of FPS students attend the Agriscience School and the Global Studies Program in Norwalk.

Fairfield has two preschool programs for three and four year olds. Families may qualify for free or reduced tuition and free transportation, based on their financial status, and may attend from any of our elementary school districts. Once the preschool program is completed, the child may be permanently enrolled in the "out of home district" elementary school and siblings may also attend.

We continue our partnerships with the CT Teacher Residency Program, an alternate route to certification, and the Farrington College of Education at Sacred Heart University, so that we are intentional about growing our own qualified and diverse teacher pipeline. Residents and interns are eligible for full-time teaching positions upon completion of the program and certification requirements. Additionally, school equity teams facilitate staff training, we have a district-wide equity assessment, and representatives from our PTA and Inclusive Fairfield are recruiting parents for diversity, equity, and inclusion work with district staff.

Schools offer programs to highlight and celebrate diversity within the school and community, as well as beyond the town's borders. Fairfield Public Schools actively looks to increase our students' understanding of the world and their role within the global community. Reducing racial, social, and economic isolation will be a continual focus of district work going forward.

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Fairfield School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

All of our schools receive funds for student supplies and activities based on a per student allocation. The allocation is based on an approximation of the cost of the program per student by level, and the school receives funding based on the enrollment times the allocation. Textbooks are purchased as part of the district budget on a six year revolving schedule to support new curricula. The cost of textbooks is based on the number of students with the assumption that each student needs at least one copy of the text and those costs are built into the district budget based on our curriculum revision cycle.

Technology is provided to students based on a classroom distribution model, in which the necessary technology for every classroom at a given level (elementary, middle, high) is identified and supported in multi-year plans at the district level. Maintenance of technology equipment is also funded by the district on a five-year replacement plan. Facilities maintenance is also funded at the district level with a long term capital improvement plan to ensure all of our schools are built to capacity and in excellent condition.